

AI Voice Receptionist — How to set it up

Send this guide **ONLY** to clients on a plan that includes the AI Voice Receptionist add-on (\$349/month).

What this is for: an AI receptionist that answers your phone 24/7 — even at 11pm and on Sundays — books appointments straight into your Tradio calendar, and texts you when something needs your attention. To make it work, your phone has to forward to our AI number, either always or only when you can't pick up.

Time required: 10–15 minutes, depending on your phone provider.

What you'll need: - Your business phone (the one customers call today). - Knowledge of who provides your phone service: cellular (Verizon, AT&T, T-Mobile), VOIP (RingCentral, OpenPhone, Grasshopper, Nextiva, etc.), or a traditional landline.

Quick chooser

Your phone setup	Path
I use my cell phone as the business line	Path A — Cellular forwarding
I have a VOIP service (RingCentral, OpenPhone, Grasshopper, etc.)	Path B — VOIP forwarding
I have a landline desk phone (POTS) at the office	Path C — Landline forwarding
I want a separate "marketing-only" number that goes to AI 100% of the time	Path D — New dedicated number

Step 0 (everyone) — We assign you an AI number

Once you sign up for the add-on, we send you an email with **your dedicated AI number** — looks like (305) 555-0199 or similar. **You forward your existing business phone to this number** (full forward, after-hours forward, or busy forward, depending on what you pick below).

Your customers never see this number. They keep calling the same business number they always have.

Path A — Cellular forwarding (Verizon, AT&T, T-Mobile, US Mobile)

Pick what kind of forwarding you want:

Option	What happens	Who it's for
Conditional forward (recommended)	If you don't pick up in 4 rings OR your line is busy OR phone is off, the call rolls to AI. You pick up most calls yourself; AI catches what you miss.	Solo operators / 2–3 person shops
Always forward	Every call goes straight to AI. AI texts you the urgent ones. You never see a "missed call" because there are none.	Contractors who don't want to answer phones at all
After-hours forward	Calls forward to AI only outside business hours (e.g., after 5pm + weekends). During business hours, your phone rings normally.	Shops with a daytime receptionist already

Step 1 — Set the forward

On your phone keypad, dial one of these and press call:

- **Always forward:** *72 then your AI number (e.g., *72 3055550199)
- **Forward when busy:** *68 then your AI number (some carriers — check yours)
- **Forward when no answer:** *92 then your AI number (some carriers)
- **Cancel any forward:** *73

Heads-up: these codes work on Verizon, AT&T, T-Mobile, and most US carriers. If they don't work for yours, log into your carrier's portal (myverizon.com, att.com, t-mobile.com) → Phone settings → Call Forwarding → set up there.

Step 2 — Test

From a different phone, call your business number. Let it ring out. Verify the AI answers ("Hi, thanks for calling [Your Business] — how can I help?").

Step 3 — Confirm with us

Reply to your kickoff email: "*Forwarding active.*" We turn on the AI script and start handling calls.

Path B — VOIP forwarding

Most VOIP providers have a "Call forwarding rules" screen in the admin panel. The general flow:

Step 1 — Find Call Forwarding settings

Login URLs by provider: - **RingCentral**: service.ringcentral.com → Phone System → Auto-Receptionist → Call Handling - **OpenPhone**: openphone.com → Settings → Phone Numbers → Call Routing - **Grasshopper**: grasshopper.com → Settings → Forwarding - **Nextiva**: nextiva.com → Voice → Call Routing - **Vonage**: Admin Portal → Phone System → Call Routing

Step 2 — Add a forwarding rule

- **Forward all calls** to: your AI number (we sent you this in your kickoff email)
- OR: **forward when no answer** with a 4-ring threshold
- OR: **forward outside business hours** with hours configured

Step 3 — Test + confirm

Same as Path A — call from a different phone, verify AI answers, then reply to kickoff email.

Heads-up: if you can't find the right setting in your VOIP admin panel, email us with the name of your provider and we'll send you a 30-second screen recording from our side showing exactly where to click.

Path C — Landline forwarding (POTS, traditional desk phone)

Less common in 2026, but if you still have a copper-line desk phone:

Step 1 — Check with your phone company

Call your landline provider (AT&T, Verizon, CenturyLink, Frontier, etc.) and ask: *"I want to set up call forwarding on my business line."*

Most charge **\$3–10/month** for landline call forwarding. Some require a one-time activation fee.

Confirm: - Cost per month - Whether they support **conditional forwarding** (busy / no-answer) or only **all-call forwarding** - The activation code (commonly *72 to start, *73 to cancel — but varies)

Step 2 — Activate

Once they confirm forwarding is enabled on your account, dial the activation code on the phone followed by your AI number. Example: *72 3055550199 .

Step 3 — Test + confirm

Same as above.

Honest take: if you're still on landline-only, this is a good moment to consider switching to VOIP. RingCentral or OpenPhone is ~\$30/month, more flexible, works from your cell. We can recommend a setup if you want — ask in your kickoff email.

Path D — New dedicated number (no forwarding from existing line)

Some clients want a **separate marketing number** that goes to AI 100% of the time, used only for ads, website, and Google Business Profile. The existing personal/office phone keeps ringing normally for old customers.

What we do

1. Provision a new local number in your area code via Tradio.
2. Update your website, GBP, and ad campaigns to use that new number.
3. Route every call to AI from the start.

What you do

1. Confirm in onboarding which area code you want.
2. Decide: do you also want the new number printed on truck wraps, business cards, etc.? (We can stage rollout.)

Trade-off vs. forwarding

- **Pro:** clean separation, AI sees 100% of marketing calls, you see 0% of them unless AI escalates.
- **Con:** existing customers calling your personal/office line bypass AI completely. If a regular calls your old number for an emergency at midnight, AI doesn't catch it.

For most clients, **Path A or B** (forward existing number) is the better choice. **Path D** makes sense for clients with a strong existing personal line they don't want to disturb.

What happens next

Once forwarding is active: - **Day 1:** AI starts answering calls in our generic "[Your Business] — how can I help?" voice. Within 48 hours we customize the greeting using your business name, hours, and

primary services from Form_02. - **Week 1:** we listen to the first 20–30 AI calls to refine the script — tightening transfer rules (which calls go to your cell), filling in trade-specific FAQ ("Do you do same-day service? What's your service area?"), and improving booking flow. - **Ongoing:** every booked appointment lands in your Tradio calendar. Every transferred call goes to your cell. Every voicemail from AI is logged + texted to you. You see all of it in your monthly report.

Common issues

"What if AI doesn't understand a customer?" AI is trained to escalate gracefully. If it can't book or answer in 3 attempts, it says: *"Let me get the owner — can I have your number to text it to you, and we'll call you back in 5 minutes?"* You get an SMS with the customer's number + summary of what they called about. You decide if/when to call back.

"Will customers know it's AI?" A small percentage will. The voice is intentionally human-sounding but if asked directly *"Are you a robot?"*, AI is trained to say: *"I'm the AI receptionist for [Your Business]. I can book appointments and answer most questions, or I can connect you to the owner — which would you prefer?"* Honesty avoids legal issues in some states.

"My voicemail is intercepting before AI can pick up." On most phones, **voicemail kicks in at 5 rings**. Set your forwarding to trigger at **4 rings** so AI gets the call before voicemail. If you can't set ring count, switch to "always forward" or call your carrier to lower voicemail trigger.

"Forwarding is costing me \$0.10 per minute on my cellular plan." Some carriers charge for forwarded minutes. If this is happening, switch to **conditional forwarding** (no-answer only) which forwards far fewer calls, or upgrade to a VOIP plan (\$30/month flat) where forwarding is included. We can advise on switching.

Questions: support@adverton.net